uncompromising, maximalist approach based on its ideological positions. This does not mean that it has no interest at all in wooing minorities. The slogan ‘Sabka Saath, Sabka Vikas aur Sabka Vishwas’ (With All, for Everybody’s Development and Everybody’s Trust) is a case in point. As Modi declared in a speech after winning the Lok Sabha 2019 polls: ‘They [minorities] cannot be handed over to them [Opposition], who benefit because we keep quiet.’[32] Like CAA, his government’s primary Muslim-linked legislation on criminalising triple talaq was aimed as much at a wider messaging to Hindus as it was to the minorities. The one outstanding issue in the BJP’s core manifesto targets that it has not yet fulfilled is the promulgation of a Uniform Civil Code. The triple talaq law, by demolishing an element of Muslim personal law, therefore had wider significance for the party. Modi, of course, presented it as a progressive step for Muslim women and as a welfare measure for the community. As he said in a 2019 rally in Dhanbad:[33]

We had said that the bad practice of triple talaq, which had turned the lives of crores of sisters to a life of hell, we will save our sisters and mothers from this badness. Today we have made a strong law against triple talaq. This law has protected the lives of lakhs and crores of our Muslim sisters and daughters. This has freed them of a big worry in life. Did I not fulfil my promise? I never worried about vote banks. My intention is to work for the benefit of people. Did I do it or not? Some people have this misunderstanding that the law the Modi government has made for triple talaq will only benefit Muslim sisters. It will surely help Muslim sisters but it will help Muslim brothers even more. For any brother, if his sister comes home after triple talaq, won’t her brother be troubled? If a daughter comes home after triple talaq, won’t her father be deeply troubled? A daughter, father, mother and whole family gets destroyed, and this is why by bringing this law against triple talaq we have also helped Muslim men.

The fact that instantaneous triple talaq has long been banned in almost two dozen Islamic countries—including Pakistan, Turkey, Indonesia, Egypt, Saudi Arabia[34]—allowed the BJP to present the